INTERVIEW

CEO/BREGUET

HOW DO YOU REINVENT A 225-YEAR-OLD INVENTION?

Breguet's CEO, Gregory Kissling, reveals the thinking behind four distinctive tourbillons, from reworked historical mechanics and fresh guilloché to a night sky transformed into a wearable memory.

Dhiram Shah

At Breguet, history is not so much a burden as a mechanism to be kept in motion. For the 225th anniversary of Abraham-Louis Breguet's tourbillon, the maison has unveiled four markedly different interpretations of watchmaking's most celebrated invention. In this conversation, Chief Executive Gregory Kissling explains why one commemorative piece would have been "too easy", how the Classique Tourbillon 7357 reworks a historically important calibre without erasing its character, and why a new guilloché motif can be as faithful to Breguet as an archival design. The engineer-turned-CEO also reflects on knowing when complexity stops serving a watch; the romance of wearing a remembered sky, and why the maison is prepared to wait before opening a boutique in India.



For the tourbillon's 225th anniversary, Breguet chose four very different interpretations rather than a single halo watch. Was the primary ambition to advance the tourbillon mechanically, or to demonstrate how many identities Breguet can give its most famous invention?

Both, but the starting point was really the Tourbillon itself. After 225 years, simply creating one anniversary piece would perhaps have been too easy. We wanted to show that this invention is still very much alive and that there are still different ways to explore it.

The four watches have very different personalities, but they all start from the same idea: how can we